



Figure 3: Files and folders

These are the default file permissions:

```
root@puppet-client:~# ls -l /home/ | grep lfy
drwxr-xr-x  8 lfy  lfyforum 4096 2010-10-27 22:08 lfy
```

How do you set directory permissions? Adding these lines to the same file should help:

```
file
{
  "/home/lfy":
    mode => 700,
    require => User["lfy"]
}
```

Why did we use the attribute *require*? It's so that there are no errors when Puppet tries to apply permissions to a non-existent folder. Here, it will only run when Puppet confirms that the user has been created first. This should give an output as shown below:

```
notice: /Stage[main]/File[/home/lfy]/mode: mode changed '755' to '700'
```

```
root@puppet-client:~# ls -l /home/ | grep lfy
drwx----- 8 lfy  lfyforum 4096 2010-10-27 22:08 lfy
```

Run an "id" on the user "lfy", to see if the user was created properly:

```
root@puppet-client:~# id lfy
uid=1001(lfy) gid=1001(lfyforum) groups=1001(lfyforum)
```

Pretty simple, right? Just imagine thousands of machines doing this at the same time, while you don't have to intervene

at all! As far as Puppet is concerned, it's the maximum use of the client's power. The server comes into the picture only when configurations are to be pulled. I hope you haven't forgotten about putting *puppetd* in *cron*, as mentioned in the last article in this series.

User deletion

What about user deletion? Just reverse a few entries in the user and file stanzas:

```
user
{
  "lfy":
    ensure => "absent"
}

file
{
  "/home/lfy":
    ensure => absent,
    force => true,
    require => User["lfy"]
}
```

Why did we use *force*? Because, by default, Puppet plays safe and does not use "*rm -rf*" on the home folder. The *force* attribute does just that.

Now tell me... A user/admin left the organisation and you need to remove his/her home folder for security reasons of your organisation. Can you remove/delete the home folder through any LDAP service? Hope now you have got the solution to that as well.

I hope you enjoyed creating users, groups and files/folders with Puppet. In the next article, we will look at something even more interesting: the management of passwords, sudo users, and a little bit about setting up Puppet on a machine during installation itself. 

References

- 1) <http://itandme.com/using-puppet-to-manage-users-passwords-and-ss>
- 2) <http://www.rev2.org/wp-content/uploads/2009/06/twitter-users.jpg>
- 3) <http://www.tecnrd.com/wp-content/uploads/2009/08/folders.jpg>

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